

Maria Silva

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01 September 2026

Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the Private Client Paralegal role at the Wokingham firm because the work sits close to what I do daily at Citizens Advice, where I advise clients on welfare, housing and family matters, often involving vulnerable individuals navigating complex rules with significant personal consequences. Moving into a dedicated private client team feels like the right next step.

At Citizens Advice East Berkshire I manage matters end to end: taking detailed instructions, establishing chronologies, researching eligibility criteria, drafting correspondence and applications, and maintaining confidential case records throughout. Many of the clients I see are dealing with difficult circumstances, so translating procedural requirements into clear, practical guidance is a central part of the role. That client-facing work, combined with the file management it requires, maps directly onto the day-to-day responsibilities of a private client paralegal.

Before that, I spent a year at Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner. In the Real Estate Disputes rotation I prepared electronic hearing bundles, assisted with skeleton arguments, maintained matter records on iManage and tracked deadlines across several competing matters simultaneously. In International Arbitration I became the sole junior supporting the team in the weeks before a significant submission deadline, coordinating documents and tracking outstanding actions to ensure everything was filed on time. A partner and associate both gave feedback that my performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor. The habits those placements built around document management, deadline discipline and working carefully under pressure are ones I have carried into every role since.

What draws me specifically to private client work is the combination of technical legal analysis and the trust clients place in practitioners handling matters that are often deeply personal. The succession-planning context you mention suggests the firm is investing in someone for the longer term, which suits me: I want to develop genuine expertise in this area, not move through it quickly.

I hold a Law LLB (2:1) from UCL and a Merit LLM in Comparative and International Dispute Resolution from Queen Mary, and I am based in Maidenhead, a short commute from Wokingham.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva